

SAGARIKA KANCHIBAIL

User Experience Researcher

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SUMMARY

- Senior UX Researcher, 5+ years leading end-to-end research across ambiguous, 0-to-1 problem spaces: interviews, field studies, concept and prototype testing, and mixed-methods surveys, for AI-native platform products.
- Turns customer evidence into binding roadmap decisions. Reframed a platform migration strategy around a validated adoption barrier, and built the AI-assisted research workflow now mentored across the team, cutting turnaround from 6 weeks to 2.

WORK EXPERIENCE

ServiceNow | Santa Clara

Senior UX Researcher, Platform UX (AI-Native Migration)

Aug 2021 – Present

- Research lead for a 0-to-1, ambiguous AI-native migration portfolio.** Set project-based research plans and led quarterly roadmap reviews across three concurrent studies (Fletcher Cove, AI Experience Adoption, Ambient Command), translating agentic AI concepts into intuitive, trustworthy user outcomes.
- Led a **mixed-methods adoption study** (interviews plus n=123 decision-maker survey) that found business disruption, not cost, as the top migration barrier (**74% vs. 46%**), reframing the 2026 roadmap around risk reduction over ROI messaging.
- Quantified migration urgency (**90% evaluating or committed**) and synthesized findings into a binding "Adoption Contract" (P1/P2 conditions), **driving Director+ leadership to replace a single-path plan** with a phased assess-pilot-migrate model.
- Ran **1:1 prototype interviews** evaluating AI Processing and Citation concepts, de-risking trust and discoverability gaps pre-launch and **driving progressive-disclosure changes adopted into the Zurich and Australia releases**; co-led a **card sort confirming WCAG 2.1 AA compliance**.
- Pitched and secured funding for a new **field-research methodology** (on-site contextual inquiry), recognized with **ServiceNow's Craft Excellence Award**; co-launched **Rolling Research**, the org's first cross-BU research collaboration, **compressing the release research cycle from two cycles to one**.
- Built and mentored the UX Research org on an **AI-assisted workflow** (Claude, Copilot, Dovetail) spanning planning through synthesis, **cutting research turnaround from 6 weeks to 2** and raising research consistency across teams.
- Applied **advanced quantitative and AI-assisted methods** across the full research life cycle (planning, moderation, analysis, and synthesis) to triangulate current findings against historical research and strengthen confidence in recommendations.
- Drove **user segmentation** across all ServiceNow platform studies, recruiting by primary personas (agents, fulfillers, decision-makers, accessibility users), including **targeted recruitment of accessibility users** for reflow and keyboard-navigation testing.
- Established baseline adoption metrics with a **6-month follow-up survey** tracking shifts in customer sentiment toward the new AI-native paradigm, giving leadership a longitudinal view of adoption rather than a single snapshot.
- Collaborated with Platform researchers on a **benchmarking study** comparing end-user productivity on Next Experience versus Core UI, **rolled out to all ServiceNow customers** and used to justify continued investment in the new interface.

NASA Ames Research Center | SJSU Research Foundation

UX Researcher

Apr 2021 – May 2021

- Co-led **field and usability research** for NASA's Advanced Air Mobility program, designing protocols and running sessions for ground-steward interfaces managing unmanned aircraft traffic.
- Established **design and safety benchmarks** via literature review; **translated findings into recommendations adopted by the design team**.

Reltio | Redwood City

UX Research Intern

Jun 2020 – Dec 2020

- Led **competitive research, heuristic evaluation, and usability testing** for a new Search UI that **increased Data Steward productivity by 40%**; ran exploratory journey-mapping research for a related profile-search feature.
- Ran **heuristic evaluation and user interviews** for a Data Validation feature, **increasing Data Configurator success rate by 20%**.

SKILLS

Research methods: Interviews, field studies and ethnography, contextual inquiry, concept and prototype testing (paper and iterative), usability testing, journey mapping, card sorting, heuristic evaluation, persona development, survey design, benchmarking and UXQ metrics.

Quantitative: Regressions, ANOVA/t-tests, survey response effects analysis, behavioral and usage analytics.

Leadership: Stakeholder and executive influence, research strategy and roadmap gating, cross-functional program management in matrixed orgs, mentorship.

AI and tools: Claude and Copilot-assisted research workflows, GreatQuestion, Qualtrics, MUIQ, Miro, Dovetail, UserZoom, UserInterviews, R, SPSS.

EDUCATION

M.S., Human Factors/Ergonomics (HCI Emphasis) · San Jose State University	2019 – 2021
Postgraduate Certificate, Business Psychology · University of Manchester	2017 – 2018
B.A., Psychology · Bangalore University	2014 – 2017